

Flock Safety / ALPR

Privacy, Accountability & Public Safety

Tell City Police Department • Common Council Briefing



Purpose

Provide a transparent, fact-based briefing on what the system captures, how TCPD uses it, what privacy risks exist, and what safeguards can govern continued operation.

Current Cost Framework

How long as TCPD managed Flock Cameras?

TCPD joined Flock in 2021 and started with four (4) cameras.

How Many Cameras does TCPD contract with now?

TCPD currently manages six (6) cameras, strategically positioned within the community.

What does it cost to manage the cameras?

The management of six (6) cameras cost \$15,000 yearly. TCPD Current Flock contract expires in 2028.

Executive Summary

The policy question is not simply “technology or no technology.”

What the cameras capture

Point-in-time images of vehicles in public view, license-plate information, vehicle characteristics, date/time, and camera location.

What they do not do

Flock states the ALPR product does not use facial recognition, does not record conversations, and does not provide continuous GPS tracking.

Where privacy controls matter

Retention, user access, search purpose, audit/review, data sharing, evidence preservation, and public transparency.

Sources: Flock Safety LPR Usage & Privacy Policy (updated June 30, 2026); Flock Safety Trust Center; Lafayette, IN municipal ALPR FAQ.

How Flock ALPR Works

A camera records a vehicle passing a defined location; investigators can search the resulting event data.

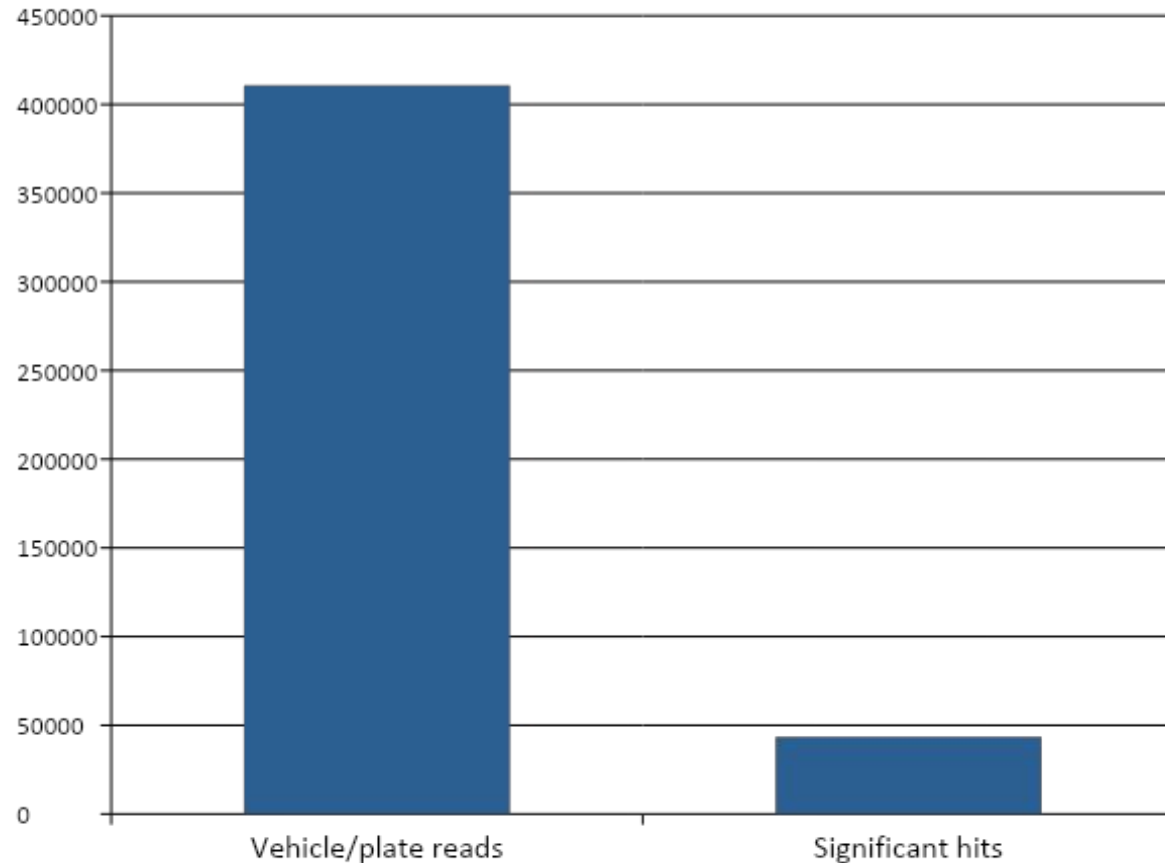


Important limitation

An ALPR alert or database match is an investigative lead—not, by itself, proof that a person committed a crime or that enforcement action is justified.

Tell City: 2025 System Activity

TCPD-reported figures show substantial system activity; activity alone does not establish investigative outcomes.



6 cameras

Current Tell City Flock ALPR network referenced by TCPD.

410,744

Vehicle/plate reads reported for 2025.

43,324

“Significant hits” reported for 2025; a hit is not necessarily a confirmed crime or violation.

Source for Tell City figures: TCPD internal 2025 system activity report / briefing data. Verify final numbers against current Flock Insights export before public release.

Every Alert Has a Story

The examples below represent just a few of the many public safety successes made possible through the responsible use of ALPR in Tell City.

September 2021- Shooting in Residential Area

Flock captured the suspect vehicle just minutes after the shooting on Highway 66. Suspect (s) were quickly apprehended.

December 2025- Stolen Trailer owned by City

Just moments after the theft, a similar vehicle crossed a Flock camera on the bridge into Hawesville, Kentucky. The truck was pulling the stolen trailer. The images were clear enough to identify the plate number of the vehicle and identify the trailer belonging to the city.

December 2025- Residential Burglaries (Burglen Hills)

Suspicious vehicle seen by a neighbor matched to Flock led to a connection of an interstate criminal organization.

May 2023- Fatal Hit and Run

Two citizens were struck by a large truck while riding a motorized scooter, leaving one dead and other badly injured. Investigating officers were able to check a nearby Flock camera and obtain a plate number from a truck matching the description.

March 2023- Missing Child/Abduction

14-year-old Tell City resident was reported missing. A doorbell camera captured a vehicle believed to be involved in the incident. Flock helped our investigators identify and track that vehicle, ultimately leading officers to the child in northern Indiana within a matter of hours. The individual with the child was later identified as a violent registered sex offender.

July & September 2026- Missing Endangered Adult

Missing elderly man from an assisted living facility in Evansville alerted by a local Flock camera and stopped by TCPD.

Missing couple with dementia reported missing from Tell City located by use of Flock in Henderson Kentucky and reunited with family.

What Privacy Concerns Are Legitimate?

The strongest privacy questions concern governance and use—not merely the presence of cameras.

Retention

How long should non-evidence data exist?

Access

Who can search the system?

Purpose

What reasons justify a search?

Sharing

Which agencies may access Tell City data?

Misuse

How is improper searching detected and addressed?

Transparency

What can the public know about the program?

These are governance questions reflected in current ALPR transparency discussions by Indiana municipalities, including Lafayette and West Lafayette.

Current Flock Privacy & Security Controls

Flock's June–August 2026 updates materially changed the privacy posture of the platform.

7-day default retention

Flock's current LPR policy states data is hard-deleted on a rolling 7-day basis by default, unless law or customer policy requires otherwise.

Individual authentication

Access is tied to approved users; Flock states there are no shared logins for system access.

Search logging

Queries are recorded with user, time, purpose and search elements for audit purposes.

Encryption

Flock states data is encrypted in transit and at rest.

Customer-controlled sharing

Flock states sharing is opt-in and controlled by the customer.

New accountability tools

Flock announced required case codes, Audit Assistance and proactive lockout measures for law-enforcement customers by the end of 2026.

Source: Flock Safety LPR Usage & Privacy Policy (June 30, 2026); Flock Safety, "Updates Privacy, Accountability, Security, and Transparency Safeguards" (Aug. 13, 2026). Vendor-reported controls should be independently verified in the City's contract and system configuration.

What the System Does NOT Do

Separating actual system capabilities from common assumptions is central to an informed privacy discussion.

No facial recognition

The ALPR product is vehicle-focused, not a biometric face-identification system.

No continuous GPS

A detection is a point-in-time event at a camera location; the system does not continuously follow a vehicle between cameras.

No conversations

The ALPR camera is not an audio surveillance device.

No automatic traffic citation

A plate read or alert does not itself issue a traffic ticket.

No unrestricted public database

Flock states public users cannot browse law-enforcement ALPR data.

No automatic sharing

Flock states agencies choose whether to participate in sharing relationships.

Sources: Flock Safety Trust Center; Lafayette, IN Flock Safety FAQ. Capabilities can vary by product/configuration; this deck addresses TCPD's ALPR use.

Frequent Questions

Can police stop someone because of an ALPR alert?

No. Every alert must be independently verified before enforcement action.

Who owns the data?

Law enforcement agencies retain ownership and control of ALPR data. Vendors should not own or sell it.

Can ALPR identify a vehicle owner?

No. Registered owner information is available only through separate secure state databases governed by federal law.

Does ALPR photograph drivers?

In Indiana, ALPR cameras are generally configured to capture the rear of passing vehicles rather than drivers or passengers.

Is ALPR constitutional?

Courts have consistently upheld ALPR when used with appropriate legal safeguards, policies, and oversight.

Who can access ALPR information?

Only authorized agencies and trained users with a legitimate law enforcement purpose. Access is controlled and audited.

Indiana Context

Indiana agencies already operate under policies emphasizing legitimate law-enforcement use, training, access controls and verification.

Tell City Police ALPR Policy

Authorized Uses (examples)

1. Criminal investigations;
2. Locating stolen vehicles or license plates;
3. Locating wanted, missing, endangered, or at-risk persons;
4. Identifying or locating vehicles associated with an investigation;
5. Assisting with calls for service and public safety incidents;
6. Developing or corroborating investigative leads;
7. Reviewing historical vehicle information when reasonably related to an authorized investigation;
8. Responding to credible threats to life or public safety;
9. Traffic-safety investigations supported by legitimate law enforcement information;

Tell City Police ALPR Policy

Auditing and Oversight

The Department shall periodically review ALPR system access and use and shall conduct an audit at least annually.

Audits may include:

- User access;
- Search activity;
- Search justifications;
- Information sharing;
- Account activity;
- Administrative changes;
- System configuration;
- Retention compliance; and
- Potential misuse.

Sources: Indiana State Police ENF-017 License Plate Reader SOP; Court of Appeals of Indiana, Devante Shakur Foster v. State, Opinion 25A-CR-325 (May 29, 2026).

Lessons From Other Indiana Communities

Local governments are increasingly responding to ALPR questions with transparency, policy limits and public education.

Lafayette

Published a public FAQ describing what its ALPR system captures, what it does not capture, authorized uses, retention, access and legal context.

West Lafayette

Announced a September 2026 public information session focused on privacy, civil rights, access, retention, audits, sharing and limitations.

Fort Wayne

In August 2026, city leadership publicly described the decision process surrounding its Flock contract and emphasized both investigative value and community trust.

Sources: City of Lafayette Flock Safety FAQ (2026); City of West Lafayette public information notice (Aug. 24, 2026); City of Fort Wayne Chief's statement (Aug. 31, 2026).

A Strong Local Privacy Framework

If Tell City continues ALPR, the strongest protection is a clear local rule set that is stricter than the minimum.

Purpose-limited searches

Require a documented law-enforcement purpose and prohibit curiosity/personal-use searches.

Role-based access

Limit accounts to personnel with a defined operational need; remove access promptly when roles change.

Mandatory case/reference number

Require a case number or documented reason for each search, with an emergency exception that triggers review.

7-day standard retention

Adopt the current 7-day default for non-preserved data; preserve only specific evidence tied to an investigation.

Sharing by written policy

Define which agencies may access data, for what offense categories, and under what agreement.

Quarterly audit

Require command-level review of search logs, exceptions, sharing and policy violations.

Annual public report

Publish aggregate use statistics, retention settings, sharing partners, policy changes and audit findings.

Training & discipline

Require initial/annual training and establish consequences for unauthorized use.

Proposed Transparency Measures

Make the program easy for residents and council members to understand and scrutinize.

Public policy

Publish the TCPD ALPR policy and retention/sharing rules.

Camera map / locations

Publish locations when disclosure is legally and operationally appropriate; explain any withheld security information.

Use statistics

Report searches, alerts, evidence preservations, sharing activity and policy exceptions in aggregate.

Audit summary

Provide council with an annual summary of access reviews and any substantiated misuse.

Community FAQ

Explain in plain language what is captured, what is not, how long it remains, and who can access it.

Council review

Establish a recurring review point so the program is not treated as “set and forget.”

Key Takeaways

A transparent program can address legitimate privacy concerns while preserving an investigative tool.

1 • Define the boundaries

The most important privacy protections are clear rules governing purpose, access, retention and sharing.

2 • Minimize the data

A short default retention period limits the amount of historical information available for unrelated searches.

3 • Make use accountable

Search logs, audits, case references, training and public reporting create a record of how the technology is actually used.

Bottom line: the council can evaluate the technology and the safeguards separately—then establish the local rules it believes are appropriate.

Sources & Reference Material

Primary and municipal sources used in this briefing.

- Flock Safety — License Plate Reader Usage and Privacy Policy, updated June 30, 2026.
- Flock Safety — “Updates Privacy, Accountability, Security, and Transparency Safeguards,” Aug. 13, 2026.
- Flock Safety Trust Center — Law Enforcement Data Access; Data Privacy & Protection, accessed Sept. 2026.
- Indiana State Police — ENF-017 License Plate Reader Standard Operating Procedure.
- Indiana Court of Appeals — Devante Shakur Foster v. State, Opinion 25A-CR-325, May 29, 2026.
- City of Lafayette, Indiana — Flock Safety Cameras Frequently Asked Questions, 2026.
- City of West Lafayette, Indiana — Understanding WLPD’s Use of Automated License Plate Readers, Aug. 24, 2026.
- City of Fort Wayne — Chief Statement on Flock, Aug. 31, 2026.
- TCPD — internal 2025 Flock activity figures used for this briefing; verify against current Flock Insights export before publication.